Chapter Forty-Two

The Sixth Crusade

Between 1223 and 1229,
Frederick II recaptures Jerusalem with no bloodshed
and has pig intestines hurled at him in thanks

Neither Andrew of Hungary nor the Holy Roman Emperor Frederick had been present for the surrender of Damietta in 1221; Andrew, because he had gone home from the Fifth Crusade early; Frederick, because he had never arrived.

Promising again and again to descend on the Crusade in glory, complete with German reinforcements, Frederick II had always found a reason not to leave Germany. Now the Fifth Crusade was over; but Frederick had vowed that he would go on crusade, and the sacred promise still had to be fulfilled. In 1223, he assured Honorius III that he would be ready to go by 1225. In 1225, he postponed the planned trip east another two years.[1]

Frederick was newly married to his second wife Yolande, but the delay wasn't due to wedded bliss. He was thirty-one, Yolande was fourteen, and the wedding had been celebrated by proxy. She was the daughter of King John of Jerusalem (whose kingdom, ruled from Acre, no longer actually *included* Jerusalem) and the rightful heir to the crown; John, although claiming the title of king, was merely her regent. And John hadn't even *been* in Acre for the